

THE CROCHET BACKPACK COLLECTION

YOUR SHOP SYSTEM · 5 PARTS

The Sold-Out Backpack *Shop*TM

The 30-day plan to turn your finished backpacks into your first orders — without paid ads. Etsy, Facebook Marketplace, Instagram and the moms at school pickup.



Welcome to your shop

Your bonus “How to Price & Sell” told you **what to charge**. This book is the other half: **who is going to pay it, where they are, and exactly what to say to them**. Everything here is ready to copy, fill in and use today.

1 The 30-Day Sold-Out Shop Blueprint

Day-by-day: task, time and expected result — from zero followers to your first 30 orders.

2 12 Etsy Listing Templates + 40 Keywords

Title, 13 tags, full description and attributes for 12 backpack types — plus the words moms actually type.

3 The Phone Photo Studio

A \$5 home setup and the 15 shots that make a \$20-in-yarn backpack look like \$85.

4 50 Copy-Paste DM & Comment Scripts

From “so cute!” to “here’s my payment” — compliments, price, shipping, colors, objections, follow-up, custom orders, closing.

5 The Back-to-School & Holiday Order Calendar

US, UK/IE and AU/NZ dates, what to post each month and when to open pre-orders.

+ Printable planners

Pricing worksheet · 30-day tracker · order log · pre-order capacity planner.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

- Do **one day per day**. Most days take under an hour. If you miss a day, just continue from where you are — don’t restart.
- Everything in **[brackets]** is for you to fill in: your prices, your colors, your town, your dates.
- Print the planners at the back and stick the tracker on your fridge. What gets written down gets done.

A QUICK WORD ON HONESTY

Every shop is different: your town, your prices and your hours all change the numbers. The targets in this book are what a steady beginner can aim for by following every day — not a promise. Most sellers who follow the plan see their first orders in Week 2, because they start with the people who already know them.

PART 1

The 30-Day Sold-Out Shop Blueprint

Four weeks, one task per day. Week 1 you build, Week 2 you sell to people who know you, Week 3 strangers find you, Week 4 you fill the order book.

Your 30-day scoreboard

CHECKPOINT	WHAT SHOULD BE IN PLACE	REALISTIC ORDER TARGET
Day 7	Shop live · 3 listings · warm list of 50	0 orders (that is normal)
Day 14	3–5 Marketplace listings · 5 groups · color menu	3–6 orders
Day 21	6 Etsy listings · first reviews · first Reel	10–15 orders incl. pre-orders
Day 30	9 listings · pre-order window open	20–30 orders (paid + deposits)

THE PRICING RULE WE USE IN THIS BOOK

Price = materials + (hours × \$12) + \$5 for packaging & platform fees, rounded up to the next \$5.

Example: \$20 yarn & hardware + 5 h × \$12 + \$5 = \$85 (women's mini). A school backpack with \$14 and 4 h = \$67 → **\$70**. A toddler mini with \$9 of cotton and 2.5 h = \$44 → **\$45**.

WHERE THE FIRST 30 ORDERS USUALLY COME FROM

Warm list & personal profile: **~40%** · Local mom groups & Marketplace: **~30%** · Etsy search: **~20%** · Instagram: **~10%** (typical split for a brand-new shop; Etsy grows every month after that)

Week 1 • Build the shop (Days 1–7)

No selling yet. You build three things that make every later day easier: a small product line with honest prices, photos that sell, and a live Etsy shop. Target at the end of the week: shop live, 3 listings, a list of 50 people.

DAY

1

☐ Choose your 3 hero backpacks and price them

Pick 3 patterns from your collection: one toddler mini, one school-size kids' backpack, one women's mini. Time yourself on a swatch or your last project and fill in the Pricing Worksheet (page at the back): materials + (hours × \$12) + \$5 packaging & fees, rounded up to the next \$5. Write the three prices on a sticky note on your fridge.

⌚ 60 min

✓ Result: A 3-item product line with prices you can defend (typical: \$45 / \$70 / \$85).

DAY

2

☐ Get 2 samples finished

You cannot sell from an empty basket. Finish (or start) two backpacks in your two best-selling colors: one neutral (cream, oat, sage) and one bright (coral, mustard, pink). Weave in ends, block the flap, and sew straps twice.

⌚ 2–3 h (keep going on Days 3–7)

✓ Result: 2 photo-ready samples. Samples are also your first stock.

DAY

3

☐ Set up your Phone Photo Studio and shoot the hero

Follow the setup in Part 3. Shoot shots 1–8 of the Phone Photo Studio list on your best sample. Take 5 frames of each and keep the sharpest.

⌚ 90 min

✓ Result: 8 clean photos: enough for your first Etsy listing.

DAY

4

☐ Open your Etsy shop and publish listing #1

Shop name (2–3 words, easy to spell, no numbers), a square shop icon (photo of your best backpack), shop policies (returns: 14 days for unused items; custom orders: final sale). Publish listing #1 using the matching template from Part 2 — copy it, then change the colors and measurements to yours.

⌚ 2 h

✓ Result: Shop live with 1 listing. It will not sell today; Etsy needs a few days to index it.

DAY

5

☐ Publish listings #2 and #3 + shipping profiles

Use templates for your other two hero backpacks. Create a shipping profile: processing time “ready to ship in 1–2 days” for finished stock, “made to order 5–10 business days” for custom. Weigh a packed backpack (usually 200–350 g / 7–12 oz) so postage is right.

⌚ 90 min

✓ Result: 3 live listings, correct postage, correct processing time.

DAY

6

☐ Turn on Instagram for the shop

Switch your account to a free professional account (or open a new one with your shop name). Bio formula: “Handmade crochet backpacks for little adventurers 🧶 · Made to order · Custom names & colors · Order below 📌”. Post 3 photos (hero, worn shot, color options) so the grid is not empty.

⌚ 60 min

✓ Result: A profile that looks like a real shop the first time a mom taps on it.

DAY

7

☐ Write your warm list of 50

Open your notes app and list 50 real people: moms from school pickup, the class group chat, coworkers with kids or grandkids, cousins, your hairdresser, your old friends from work. Put a ★ next to the 15 who have kids aged 2–8.

⌚ 45 min

✓ Result: The 50 people you will tell on Day 8. Most first orders come from this list.

Week 2 • Sell local first (Days 8–14)

Strangers on Etsy trust reviews. People who know you trust *you*. This week you get your first orders from the people who already like you, and you plant listings in the places local moms already shop. Target: first 3–6 orders.

DAY
8

☐ Soft launch: tell your people

Post on your personal Facebook and Instagram stories using DM Script #1 (Part 4, “Launch post”). Then send the personal version (Script #2) to your 15 ★ contacts, one by one — never as a group message.

⌚ 60 min

✓ Result: 3–8 replies and your first 1–2 orders or reservations.

DAY
9

☐ List 3 backpacks on Facebook Marketplace

One listing per backpack, 8–10 photos each, category “Bags & Luggage”. Title format: “Handmade Crochet Toddler Backpack — Custom Name Available”. Offer local pickup + shipping. Price the same as Etsy (never cheaper: Etsy buyers will find you).

⌚ 60 min

✓ Result: 3 live Marketplace listings visible to people within ~20 miles / 30 km.

DAY
10

☐ Join 5 local mom groups

Search Facebook for “[your town] moms”, “[your school] PTA/PTO”, “[your area] buy sell trade”, “[your town] small business”. Read each group’s rules and write down which day self-promotion is allowed (many have a “Small Business Saturday” thread).

⌚ 30 min

✓ Result: A list of 5 groups with their promo rules and days.

DAY
11

☐ Your first group post: show & tell, not an ad

In groups that allow it, post one photo of you holding a backpack with Script #3: the story of why you started, one line about custom names, and “happy to answer questions in the comments”. Never paste a price in the first post; let people ask.

⌚ 30 min

✓ Result: 10–40 reactions and a few “how much?” comments you answer with Part 4.

DAY
12

☐ Follow up everyone who reacted

Every like, heart and “so cute!” from Days 8–11 gets a personal message within 48 hours (Scripts #4–#9). Keep a simple list: name · what they liked · answered? · ordered?

⌚ 45 min

✓ Result: The first 1–3 paid orders from people who were only “looking”.

DAY
13

☐ Make your color & name menu

Photograph 8–12 yarn colors lined up on your white board (shot 9) and one close-up of an embroidered name (shot 12). Save them as a phone album called “ORDER MENU” so you can send them in 2 taps.

⌚ 60 min

✓ Result: A visual menu that turns “can you do it in pink?” into a yes in 10 seconds.

DAY
14

☐ **Weekly review: fix what nobody sees**

On Etsy: Stats → look at views per listing. Any listing under 20 views gets a new first photo and a title that starts with a keyword from the 40-keyword list. Count your messages and orders on the 30-Day Tracker.

🕒 45 min

✓ Result: Better listings for Week 3 and an honest number: usually 3–6 orders by today.

Week 3 • Get seen by strangers (Days 15–21)

Now that you have your first happy customers, you use them as proof and let Etsy, Instagram and word of mouth bring people you have never met. Target: 10–15 total orders, including pre-orders.

DAY
15

☐ Your first Reel: “20 hours in 20 seconds”

Film shot 14 (hands crocheting) in 3-second clips while you work, plus a reveal of the finished backpack on a chair or on a child’s back (no face needed). Add trending audio inside the app, caption: “From one ball of yarn to their first day of school 🧶”.

⌚ 60 min

✓ Result: A Reel that usually gets 5–20× the reach of a photo post.

DAY
16

☐ Etsy listings #4–#6: variations

Duplicate your best listing and turn it into new ones: a different animal, a new color set, a “personalized name” version. More listings = more doors into your shop. Use templates 4–9.

⌚ 90 min

✓ Result: 6 live listings. Etsy starts showing you in more searches.

DAY
17

☐ Open 5 pre-order slots for the next school event

Check the Order Calendar (Part 5) for your next date (first day of school, birthday season, Halloween, holidays). Post: “I’m opening 5 made-to-order spots for [event]. 50% deposit holds your spot, ready by [date].” Use Script #44.

⌚ 45 min

✓ Result: Pre-orders fill your calendar and put deposit money in your pocket before you buy yarn.

DAY
18

☐ Ask your first customers for a photo and a review

Send Script #46 to everyone who received a backpack. Ask for a photo of the backpack in use (face optional) and, if they bought on Etsy, a review. Always ask permission before sharing a child’s photo.

⌚ 20 min

✓ Result: Your first reviews and customer photos: the proof strangers need.

DAY
19

☐ Share day

Ask 5 happy customers or friends to share your best post in their stories or in their own class group chats (Script #48). One share from a mom with 400 local friends is worth more than a week of posting.

⌚ 30 min

✓ Result: New local followers and 2–5 new inquiries.

DAY
20

☐ Refresh Marketplace and groups

Renew or relist your Marketplace items with a new first photo (Marketplace rewards fresh listings). Post a customer photo in the groups that allow promotion: “Look who took her new backpack to preschool today 🧡”.

⌚ 30 min

✓ Result: Your listings jump back to the top of local feeds.

DAY
21

☐ **Weekly review**

Update the tracker. Which channel brought each order? Double down on the top one next week. Answer every unanswered message, even the old ones.

🕒 30 min

✓ Result: A clear picture of what works for you (usually 10–15 orders by today).

Week 4 • Fill the order book (Days 22–30)

You have proof, listings and a small audience. This week you raise the value of every order, work faster, and open your next pre-order window. Target: 20–30 orders (paid + deposits).

DAY
22

☐ Launch a sibling / friend offer

"Order 2 backpacks, save \$10." Sisters, cousins, best friends in the same class. Post it in stories and send it to every past customer (Script #41).

🕒 30 min

✓ Result: Your average order value goes up without finding a single new customer.

DAY
23

☐ Post for the next date on your calendar

Use the Order Calendar: one post and one story about the next event (Halloween treat backpack, holiday gifts, back to school in the other hemisphere). Mention the order deadline.

🕒 45 min

✓ Result: A deadline gives people a reason to decide now instead of "later".

DAY
24

☐ Etsy listings #7–#9 + a listing video

Add three more listings from the templates and a 5–15 second video to your best-viewed listing (turn the backpack, open the flap). Listings with video tend to get more clicks.

🕒 90 min

✓ Result: 9 listings and a video on your top product.

DAY
25

☐ Second group round with proof

Post a collage of 3 customer photos in each group that allows it (permission first). Caption: "5 happy little backpackers this month — 3 spots left for [event]".

🕒 30 min

✓ Result: Social proof + scarcity: the post that usually brings the most orders.

DAY
26

☐ Batch production day

Stop making one backpack at a time. Make all the straps for the week, then all the flaps, then all the bodies. Most crocheters save 20–30% of their time this way.

🕒 3 h

✓ Result: Faster delivery on every open order.

DAY
27

☐ Follow up every "maybe later"

Everyone who said "I'll think about it" or "after payday" gets Script #33 or #34. Warm, short, one question, no pressure.

🕒 30 min

✓ Result: Typically 1 in 4 "maybes" turns into an order.

DAY
28

☐ **Open your next pre-order window (10 spots)**

Use the capacity formula in Part 5: spots = weeks until the deadline × backpacks you can finish per week. Post the number of spots and the closing date. Update the count publicly as spots fill.

🕒 45 min

✓ Result: A full calendar for next month before this one is over.

DAY
29

☐ **Price check**

If your pre-order spots filled in under 48 hours, your price is too low: raise the next window by \$5. If a listing has 200+ views and no sales, test a new first photo before you touch the price.

🕒 20 min

✓ Result: More money per hour for the same backpack.

DAY
30

☐ **Month review and your next 30 days**

Total orders, total revenue, best channel, best product, best color. Write them on the tracker. Plan Month 2: repeat Weeks 3–4, add 3 listings per week, follow your calendar.

🕒 45 min

✓ Result: Your first month on paper: typically 20–30 orders — and a plan for the next 30.

12 Etsy Listing Templates

Copy, paste, edit the colors and measurements to match your backpack, publish.

Each template has a searchable title, all 13 tags (max 20 characters each, as Etsy requires), a full description and the attributes to fill in.

THE TITLE FORMULA

[What it is, in buyer words], [second way to say it], [who it's for], [occasion/gift]. Put the most-searched phrase in the first 40 characters — that's what shows in search results on phones.

THE TAG RULES

- Use all 13 tags. Max 20 characters each.
- Use phrases, not single words ("toddler backpack", not "toddler").
- Don't repeat your category or attributes as tags — Etsy already counts them.
- Change seasonal tags every season (see keyword list).

BEFORE YOU PUBLISH (EVERY LISTING)

Who made it: **I did** · What is it: **A finished product** · When was it made: **Made to order** (or 2020–2026 for ready stock) · Renewal: **Automatic** · 10 photos in the order from Part 3 · A 5–15 s video on your best listing · Shipping profile with real weight (a packed backpack is usually 200–350 g / 7–12 oz).

Selling kids' items? Children's products (12 and under) sold in the US are covered by the CPSIA; the UK, EU and Australia have their own toy & child-product rules. Avoid small detachable parts (buttons, beads, safety eyes) on toddler pieces — embroider faces instead — and check the current requirements for your country before you list.

Template 1 • Toddler Mini Backpack

Suggested \$42–\$48

TITLE (116/140 CHARACTERS)

Crochet Toddler Backpack, Handmade Mini Backpack for Toddler Girl or Boy, Soft Cotton Daycare Bag, 1st Birthday Gift

13 TAGS

toddler backpack

crochet backpack

mini backpack

daycare backpack

toddler gift

1st birthday gift

handmade backpack

kids crochet bag

cotton backpack

toddler girl gift

toddler boy gift

baby shower gift

small backpack

DESCRIPTION

Small enough for little shoulders, big enough for a snack, a sippy cup and a favorite toy.

Hand-crocheted mini backpack made just for toddlers (ages 1–3). Soft, light and washable, with adjustable straps that grow with them.

✿ SIZE: 22 × 18 × 7 cm / 8.7 × 7 × 2.8 in · Straps adjustable 30–40 cm / 12–16 in

✿ MATERIALS: 100% cotton worsted yarn · coconut or wooden button · drawstring top

✿ PERSONALIZATION: Add your child's name in chain-stitch embroidery (up to 8 letters) — choose "Personalized" at checkout.

✿ Made to order: ready to ship in 5–10 business days (ready-made colors ship in 1–2 days). Need it for a date? Tell us in the notes at checkout.

✿ Care: hand wash cold with mild soap, press out water in a towel, dry flat. Do not tumble dry.

✿ Every backpack is wrapped in tissue with a handwritten card, ready to give.

✿ Safety: made without small detachable parts on the face. Adult supervision recommended for children under 3; not a toy.

Questions about colors or sizes? Send us a message — we answer within 24 hours.

ATTRIBUTES & SETTINGS

Category Bags & Purses > Backpacks

Primary color Pink (edit to yours)

Secondary color Beige

Closure Button + drawstring

Material Cotton

Occasion Birthday

Personalization Optional (name)

Made Made to order · I did

Template 2 • Personalized Name School Backpack

Suggested \$62–\$75

TITLE (114/140 CHARACTERS)

Personalized Kids Backpack with Name, Crochet School Backpack for Girls, Custom Preschool Bag, Back to School Gift

13 TAGS

name backpack

custom kids backpack

kids backpack

preschool backpack

back to school

custom name bag

crochet backpack

school backpack

kindergarten bag

first day of school

personalized gift

girls backpack

handmade backpack

DESCRIPTION

Their name, their colors, their first-day-of-school backpack — made by hand, not in a factory.

A sturdy school-size crochet backpack (ages 3–7) with a front flap, a lined interior and your child's name stitched on the flap.

✿ SIZE: 30 × 24 × 10 cm / 12 × 9.5 × 4 in · fits an A5 / 6×9 in book and a lunch box

✿ MATERIALS: Cotton-acrylic worsted blend · cotton fabric lining · magnetic snap · padded straps

✿ PERSONALIZATION: Type the name exactly as you want it (capital letters as shown). Up to 10 letters. We send a photo of the name before we sew it on.

✿ Made to order: ready to ship in 5–10 business days (ready-made colors ship in 1–2 days). Need it for a date? Tell us in the notes at checkout.

✿ Care: hand wash cold with mild soap, press out water in a towel, dry flat. Do not tumble dry.

✿ Every backpack is wrapped in tissue with a handwritten card, ready to give.

✿ Safety: made without small detachable parts on the face. Adult supervision recommended for children under 3; not a toy.

Questions about colors or sizes? Send us a message — we answer within 24 hours.

ATTRIBUTES & SETTINGS

Category Bags & Purses > Backpacks

Primary color Your choice

Secondary color Your choice

Closure Magnetic snap

Material Cotton, Acrylic

Occasion Back to school

Personalization Yes (required)

Made Made to order · I did

Template 3 • Bunny Ears Backpack

Suggested \$48–\$58

TITLE (108/140 CHARACTERS)

Bunny Backpack for Kids, Crochet Bunny Ears Mini Backpack, Easter Gift for Toddler Girl, Handmade Rabbit Bag

13 TAGS

bunny backpack easter gift bunny ears bag crochet bunny rabbit backpack easter basket gift
toddler backpack kids backpack cute backpack girls gift handmade backpack crochet backpack
spring gift

DESCRIPTION

Two floppy ears, one tiny tail, and a backpack they will not want to take off.

Hand-crocheted bunny backpack with 3D ears, an embroidered face (no small parts) and a pompom tail. A favorite Easter basket alternative.

✿ SIZE: 24 × 20 × 8 cm / 9.5 × 8 × 3 in (ears add 9 cm / 3.5 in)

✿ MATERIALS: Soft cotton worsted · sewn-on felt details · zipper top closure

✿ PERSONALIZATION: Choose the body color and the inner-ear color. Name tag on the back available.

✿ Made to order: ready to ship in 5–10 business days (ready-made colors ship in 1–2 days). Need it for a date? Tell us in the notes at checkout.

✿ Care: hand wash cold with mild soap, press out water in a towel, dry flat. Do not tumble dry.

✿ Every backpack is wrapped in tissue with a handwritten card, ready to give.

✿ Safety: made without small detachable parts on the face. Adult supervision recommended for children under 3; not a toy.

Questions about colors or sizes? Send us a message — we answer within 24 hours.

ATTRIBUTES & SETTINGS

Category Bags & Purses › Backpacks

Primary color White / Pink / Gray

Secondary color Pink

Closure Zipper

Material Cotton

Holiday Easter

Personalization Optional (name)

Made Made to order · I did

Template 4 • Strawberry Backpack

Suggested \$45–\$55

TITLE (102/140 CHARACTERS)

Strawberry Backpack, Crochet Strawberry Bag for Girls, Cute Fruit Mini Backpack, Cottagecore Kids Gift

13 TAGS

strawberry backpack strawberry bag fruit backpack cottagecore bag crochet strawberry girls backpack
cute backpack mini backpack toddler backpack summer bag birthday gift girl handmade backpack
crochet backpack

DESCRIPTION

Bright red, sweet little seeds, a leafy green top — the backpack that gets complimented at every pickup.

A round strawberry-shaped crochet backpack with embroidered seeds and a green leaf flap. Sized for toddlers and young kids.

✿ SIZE: 23 × 21 × 7 cm / 9 × 8.3 × 2.8 in

✿ MATERIALS: Cotton worsted · leaf flap with magnetic snap · adjustable straps

✿ PERSONALIZATION: Also available as a “pink strawberry”. Name embroidery on the leaf available.

✿ Made to order: ready to ship in 5–10 business days (ready-made colors ship in 1–2 days). Need it for a date? Tell us in the notes at checkout.

✿ Care: hand wash cold with mild soap, press out water in a towel, dry flat. Do not tumble dry.

✿ Every backpack is wrapped in tissue with a handwritten card, ready to give.

✿ Safety: made without small detachable parts on the face. Adult supervision recommended for children under 3; not a toy.

Questions about colors or sizes? Send us a message — we answer within 24 hours.

ATTRIBUTES & SETTINGS

Category	Bags & Purses › Backpacks	Primary color	Red
Secondary color	Green	Closure	Magnetic snap
Material	Cotton	Occasion	Birthday
Personalization	Optional	Made	Made to order · I did

Template 5 • Granny Square Backpack

Suggested \$75–\$95

TITLE (113/140 CHARACTERS)

Granny Square Backpack, Crochet Patchwork Backpack for Women, Boho Retro Handmade Bag, Colorful Festival Backpack

13 TAGS

granny square bag granny square patchwork backpack boho backpack retro backpack festival backpack
crochet backpack womens backpack colorful backpack 70s style bag handmade bag gift for her
crochet bag

DESCRIPTION

Every square picked and joined by hand. No two are ever exactly the same.

A women's crochet backpack made from 16 joined granny squares with a drawstring top and a flap. Roomy enough for a day out.

✿ SIZE: 32 × 28 × 12 cm / 12.5 × 11 × 4.7 in

✿ MATERIALS: Acrylic-cotton worsted · fully lined · drawstring + toggle

✿ PERSONALIZATION: Choose a palette: Sunset (coral, mustard, cream), Garden (sage, pink, white) or Rainbow. Custom palettes on request.

✿ Made to order: ready to ship in 5–10 business days (ready-made colors ship in 1–2 days). Need it for a date? Tell us in the notes at checkout.

✿ Care: hand wash cold with mild soap, press out water in a towel, dry flat. Do not tumble dry.

✿ Every backpack is wrapped in tissue with a handwritten card, ready to give.

Questions about colors or sizes? Send us a message — we answer within 24 hours.

ATTRIBUTES & SETTINGS

Category	Bags & Purses › Backpacks	Primary color	Multicolor
Secondary color	Cream	Closure	Drawstring
Material	Acrylic, Cotton	Style	Boho
Personalization	Palette choice	Made	Made to order · I did

Template 6 • Daisy Flower Backpack

Suggested \$52–\$62

TITLE (102/140 CHARACTERS)

Daisy Backpack for Girls, Crochet Flower Mini Backpack, Handmade Floral Kids Bag, Spring Birthday Gift

13 TAGS

daisy backpack flower backpack floral backpack crochet flower bag girls backpack daisy gift
spring gift mini backpack kids backpack flower girl gift birthday gift girl crochet backpack
handmade backpack

DESCRIPTION

A garden of hand-crocheted daisies on a soft little backpack.

Kids' crochet backpack with 5 raised 3D daisies on the flap. A sweet birthday or flower-girl gift.

✿ SIZE: 25 × 21 × 8 cm / 10 × 8.3 × 3 in

✿ MATERIALS: Cotton worsted · flower appliqués sewn on twice · button closure

✿ PERSONALIZATION: Pick the body color: cream, sage, lilac, sky or blush.

✿ Made to order: ready to ship in 5–10 business days (ready-made colors ship in 1–2 days). Need it for a date? Tell us in the notes at checkout.

✿ Care: hand wash cold with mild soap, press out water in a towel, dry flat. Do not tumble dry.

✿ Every backpack is wrapped in tissue with a handwritten card, ready to give.

✿ Safety: made without small detachable parts on the face. Adult supervision recommended for children under 3; not a toy.

Questions about colors or sizes? Send us a message — we answer within 24 hours.

ATTRIBUTES & SETTINGS

Category	Bags & Purses › Backpacks	Primary color	Your choice
Secondary color	White	Closure	Button
Material	Cotton	Occasion	Birthday
Personalization	Color choice	Made	Made to order · I did

Template 7 • Striped Retro Backpack (women)

Suggested \$68–\$85

TITLE (106/140 CHARACTERS)

Striped Crochet Backpack for Women, Retro Handmade Mini Backpack, Cotton Everyday Bag, Unique Gift for Her

13 TAGS

striped backpack

retro backpack

womens backpack

crochet backpack

mini backpack

everyday bag

cotton backpack

gift for her

boho bag

handmade bag

vintage style bag

crochet bag

summer backpack

DESCRIPTION

The everyday backpack you will not see on anyone else.

A women's mini backpack in bold stripes, worked tight so it keeps its shape. Holds a phone, wallet, keys, sunglasses and a small water bottle.

✿ SIZE: 27 × 22 × 10 cm / 10.6 × 8.7 × 4 in

✿ MATERIALS: 100% cotton worsted · fabric lining with inside pocket · drawstring + buckle flap

✿ PERSONALIZATION: Choose 2–3 stripe colors from our color menu.

✿ Made to order: ready to ship in 5–10 business days (ready-made colors ship in 1–2 days). Need it for a date? Tell us in the notes at checkout.

✿ Care: hand wash cold with mild soap, press out water in a towel, dry flat. Do not tumble dry.

✿ Every backpack is wrapped in tissue with a handwritten card, ready to give.

Questions about colors or sizes? Send us a message — we answer within 24 hours.

ATTRIBUTES & SETTINGS

Category	Bags & Purses > Backpacks	Primary color	Your choice
Secondary color	Your choice	Closure	Drawstring + buckle
Material	Cotton	Style	Retro
Personalization	Color choice	Made	Made to order · I did

Template 8 • Boho Fringe Mini Backpack

Suggested \$65–\$80

TITLE (104/140 CHARACTERS)

Boho Crochet Backpack with Fringe, Handmade Mini Backpack for Women, Festival Bag, Bohemian Gift for Her

13 TAGS

boho backpack

fringe backpack

festival bag

bohemian bag

crochet backpack

mini backpack

womens backpack

boho gift

handmade bag

hippie bag

summer bag

gift for her

crochet bag

DESCRIPTION

Festival-ready, beach-ready, farmers'-market ready.

A women's mini backpack with a textured stitch body and a long fringe flap. Light, soft and very photogenic.

✿ SIZE: 26 × 22 × 9 cm / 10 × 8.7 × 3.5 in (fringe 10 cm / 4 in)

✿ MATERIALS: Cotton macramé cord or cotton worsted · wooden bead toggle · drawstring

✿ PERSONALIZATION: Natural, terracotta, sage or mustard.

✿ Made to order: ready to ship in 5–10 business days (ready-made colors ship in 1–2 days). Need it for a date? Tell us in the notes at checkout.

✿ Care: hand wash cold with mild soap, press out water in a towel, dry flat. Do not tumble dry.

✿ Every backpack is wrapped in tissue with a handwritten card, ready to give.

Questions about colors or sizes? Send us a message — we answer within 24 hours.

ATTRIBUTES & SETTINGS

Category	Bags & Purses › Backpacks	Primary color	Beige (edit)
Secondary color	—	Closure	Drawstring + toggle
Material	Cotton	Style	Boho
Personalization	Color choice	Made	Made to order · I did

Template 9 • Drawstring Bucket Backpack

Suggested \$50–\$60

TITLE (108/140 CHARACTERS)

Crochet Drawstring Backpack, Handmade Bucket Bag Backpack, T-Shirt Yarn Backpack for Kids or Women, Eco Gift

13 TAGS

drawstring backpack bucket backpack bucket bag crochet backpack t shirt yarn bag eco friendly bag chunky crochet bag womens backpack kids backpack handmade bag minimalist bag gift for her crochet bag

DESCRIPTION

Pull, tie, go. The simplest backpack in your closet — and the one you will grab every day.

A chunky bucket-style backpack worked in t-shirt yarn, with a round base and drawstring straps. Two sizes: kids and adult.

✿ SIZE: Kids 26 × 20 cm / 10 × 8 in · Adult 34 × 28 cm / 13.4 × 11 in · base Ø 18–22 cm / 7–8.7 in

✿ MATERIALS: Recycled t-shirt yarn · cotton cord drawstring

✿ PERSONALIZATION: Pick size and color. Leather-look name tag available.

✿ Made to order: ready to ship in 5–10 business days (ready-made colors ship in 1–2 days). Need it for a date? Tell us in the notes at checkout.

✿ Care: hand wash cold with mild soap, press out water in a towel, dry flat. Do not tumble dry.

✿ Every backpack is wrapped in tissue with a handwritten card, ready to give.

Questions about colors or sizes? Send us a message — we answer within 24 hours.

ATTRIBUTES & SETTINGS

Category	Bags & Purses > Backpacks	Primary color	Your choice
Secondary color	—	Closure	Drawstring
Material	Cotton, Recycled	Style	Minimalist
Personalization	Size & color	Made	Made to order · I did

Template 10 • Teddy Bear Backpack

Suggested \$50–\$60

TITLE (108/140 CHARACTERS)

Teddy Bear Backpack for Toddler, Crochet Bear Mini Backpack, Handmade Animal Kids Bag, Baby Boy or Girl Gift

13 TAGS

bear backpack teddy bear bag animal backpack toddler backpack crochet bear kids backpack
baby boy gift toddler boy gift cute backpack mini backpack 1st birthday gift crochet backpack
handmade backpack

DESCRIPTION

A little bear friend that carries their snacks.

Brown, cream or honey bear backpack with round ears, an embroidered snout and eyes (no buttons or beads on the face).

✿ SIZE: 23 × 20 × 8 cm / 9 × 8 × 3 in

✿ MATERIALS: Soft acrylic or cotton worsted · zipper top · adjustable straps

✿ PERSONALIZATION: Name on a heart patch on the back (up to 8 letters).

✿ Made to order: ready to ship in 5–10 business days (ready-made colors ship in 1–2 days). Need it for a date? Tell us in the notes at checkout.

✿ Care: hand wash cold with mild soap, press out water in a towel, dry flat. Do not tumble dry.

✿ Every backpack is wrapped in tissue with a handwritten card, ready to give.

✿ Safety: made without small detachable parts on the face. Adult supervision recommended for children under 3; not a toy.

Questions about colors or sizes? Send us a message — we answer within 24 hours.

ATTRIBUTES & SETTINGS

Category	Bags & Purses > Backpacks	Primary color	Brown
Secondary color	Beige	Closure	Zipper
Material	Acrylic or Cotton	Occasion	Birthday
Personalization	Optional (name)	Made	Made to order · I did

Template 11 • Kindergarten Backpack + Pencil Pouch Set

Suggested \$72–\$85

TITLE (106/140 CHARACTERS)

Kindergarten Backpack Set with Pencil Pouch, Personalized Crochet School Bag, First Day of School Gift Set

13 TAGS

kindergarten bag backpack set pencil pouch first day of school school gift set custom kids backpack
back to school name backpack crochet backpack kids backpack teacher approved school supplies
handmade backpack

DESCRIPTION

First day of school, sorted: backpack + matching pencil pouch, both with their name.

School-size crochet backpack plus a zip pencil pouch in the same colors. Lined, sturdy, easy to spot on the classroom hook.

✿ SIZE: Backpack 30 × 24 × 10 cm / 12 × 9.5 × 4 in · Pouch 20 × 9 cm / 8 × 3.5 in

✿ MATERIALS: Cotton-acrylic worsted · cotton lining · zipper pouch · loop for the classroom hook

✿ PERSONALIZATION: Name on both pieces (up to 10 letters). Order by the date on our shop announcement to receive it before school starts.

✿ Made to order: ready to ship in 5–10 business days (ready-made colors ship in 1–2 days). Need it for a date? Tell us in the notes at checkout.

✿ Care: hand wash cold with mild soap, press out water in a towel, dry flat. Do not tumble dry.

✿ Every backpack is wrapped in tissue with a handwritten card, ready to give.

✿ Safety: made without small detachable parts on the face. Adult supervision recommended for children under 3; not a toy.

Questions about colors or sizes? Send us a message — we answer within 24 hours.

ATTRIBUTES & SETTINGS

Category	Bags & Purses › Backpacks	Primary color	Your choice
Secondary color	Your choice	Closure	Magnetic snap / Zipper
Material	Cotton, Acrylic	Occasion	Back to school
Personalization	Yes (required)	Made	Made to order · I did

Template 12 • Pumpkin Trick-or-Treat Backpack

Suggested \$42–\$52

TITLE (103/140 CHARACTERS)

Pumpkin Backpack for Kids, Crochet Halloween Treat Bag, Trick or Treat Mini Backpack, Fall Toddler Gift

13 TAGS

pumpkin backpack

halloween bag

trick or treat bag

treat bag

fall backpack

halloween gift

crochet pumpkin

toddler backpack

kids backpack

halloween costume

fall gift

crochet backpack

handmade backpack

DESCRIPTION

Trick-or-treat hands-free — and still cute in November.

A round pumpkin backpack with a leafy stem flap and a wide opening that fits a full night of candy. Face or no face, your choice.

✿ SIZE: 24 × 22 × 10 cm / 9.5 × 8.7 × 4 in

✿ MATERIALS: Cotton or acrylic worsted · stem flap with snap · adjustable straps

✿ PERSONALIZATION: Classic orange, pastel peach or white “ghost” pumpkin. Name on the leaf available.

✿ Made to order: ready to ship in 5–10 business days (ready-made colors ship in 1–2 days). Need it for a date? Tell us in the notes at checkout.

✿ Care: hand wash cold with mild soap, press out water in a towel, dry flat. Do not tumble dry.

✿ Every backpack is wrapped in tissue with a handwritten card, ready to give.

✿ Safety: made without small detachable parts on the face. Adult supervision recommended for children under 3; not a toy.

Questions about colors or sizes? Send us a message — we answer within 24 hours.

ATTRIBUTES & SETTINGS

Category Bags & Purses › Backpacks

Primary color Orange

Secondary color Green

Closure Snap

Material Cotton or Acrylic

Holiday Halloween

Personalization Optional

Made Made to order · I did

The 40 keywords moms actually search

Intent tells you how close the buyer is to paying. 🛒 **Ready to buy** goes at the start of titles. 🎁 **Gift** and 📅 **Seasonal** are your rotating tags. 🔍 **Browsing** brings favorites and followers.

#	KEYWORD	INTENT	WHERE TO USE IT	WHEN IT PEAKS
1	crochet backpack	🔍 Browsing	Tag + title	All year
2	crochet backpack for kids	🛒 Ready to buy	Title only (over 20 characters — too long for a tag)	All year
3	toddler backpack	🛒 Ready to buy	Title start	All year
4	personalized toddler backpack	🛒 Ready to buy	Title only (over 20 characters — too long for a tag)	All year
5	name backpack	🛒 Ready to buy	Tag	Jun–Sep · Dec–Jan (AU)
6	personalized backpack	🛒 Ready to buy	Title only (over 20 characters — too long for a tag)	All year
7	preschool backpack	🛒 Ready to buy	Title	Jun–Sep · Nov–Jan (AU)
8	daycare backpack	🛒 Ready to buy	Tag	All year
9	kindergarten backpack	🛒 Ready to buy	Title only (over 20 characters — too long for a tag)	Jun–Sep · Nov–Jan (AU)
10	mini backpack for toddler	🛒 Ready to buy	Title only (over 20 characters — too long for a tag)	All year
11	back to school gift	🎁 Gift	Tag	Jul–Sep · Jan (AU/NZ)
12	first day of school	🎁 Gift	Tag	Jul–Sep · Jan–Feb (AU/NZ)
13	toddler birthday gift	🎁 Gift	Title only (over 20 characters — too long for a tag)	All year
14	1st birthday gift	🎁 Gift	Tag	All year
15	gift for granddaughter	🎁 Gift	Title only (over 20 characters — too long for a tag)	Nov–Dec · birthdays
16	flower girl gift	🎁 Gift	Tag	Apr–Sep (wedding season)
17	easter basket gift	📅 Seasonal	Tag	Feb–Apr
18	easter gift for kids	📅 Seasonal	Title (Feb–Apr)	Feb–Apr
19	halloween treat bag	📅 Seasonal	Title (Sep–Oct)	Aug–Oct

#	KEYWORD	INTENT	WHERE TO USE IT	WHEN IT PEAKS
20	trick or treat bag	 Seasonal	Tag	Aug–Oct
21	christmas gift for girls	 Seasonal	Title only (over 20 characters — too long for a tag)	Oct–Dec
22	valentines gift for kids	 Seasonal	Title only (over 20 characters — too long for a tag)	Jan–Feb
23	bunny backpack	 Ready to buy	Title start	Peaks Feb–Apr
24	strawberry backpack	 Ready to buy	Title start	Peaks Apr–Aug
25	bear backpack	 Ready to buy	Title start	All year
26	pumpkin backpack	 Seasonal	Title start	Aug–Oct
27	daisy backpack	 Ready to buy	Title start	Mar–Aug
28	granny square backpack	 Ready to buy	Title only (over 20 characters — too long for a tag)	All year
29	boho backpack	 Browsing	Tag	Apr–Aug
30	festival backpack	 Seasonal	Tag	May–Aug
31	cottagecore bag	 Browsing	Tag	All year
32	retro striped backpack	 Browsing	Title only (over 20 characters — too long for a tag)	All year
33	mommy and me backpack	 Gift	Title only (over 20 characters — too long for a tag)	Mother’s Day · holidays
34	matching sibling gift	 Gift	Title only (over 20 characters — too long for a tag)	Holidays · new baby
35	handmade backpack	 Browsing	Tag	All year
36	knitted backpack	 Browsing (many buyers say “knit”)	Tag	All year
37	cotton backpack	 Browsing	Tag	Spring–summer
38	eco friendly bag	 Browsing	Tag	All year
39	drawstring backpack	 Ready to buy	Title	All year
40	custom name bag	 Ready to buy	Tag	All year

HOW TO FIND YOUR OWN KEYWORDS IN 5 MINUTES

1. Type "crochet backpack" in the Etsy search bar slowly and write down every suggestion that appears.
2. Repeat with "toddler backpack", "kids backpack", "name backpack" and your animal ("bunny backpack"...).
3. Open the 3 best-selling listings for each and look at the words in their titles (not their tags — you can't see those).
4. Check your own Etsy Stats every Sunday: the "search terms" list shows exactly what people typed to find you. Use those words more.

PART 3

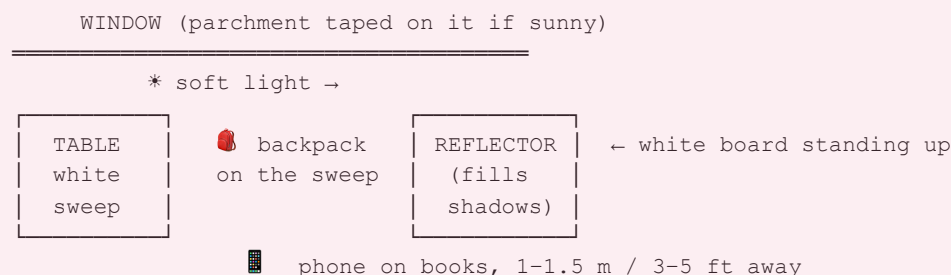
The Phone Photo Studio

Your photos are your shop window. With a window, two poster boards and your phone you can get catalog-quality photos — for under \$5.

The setup (all things you already have)

ITEM	HOW TO SET IT UP	COST
Light	One window with indirect daylight (no sun beams on the table). North-facing is ideal. Shoot between 10 am and 2 pm, or on an overcast day. Turn OFF every lamp and ceiling light — mixed light turns cream yarn yellow.	\$0
Diffuser (if sun hits the window)	Tape a sheet of baking parchment or a white shower curtain over the window. It turns hard sun into soft, even light.	\$0-\$3
Background / sweep	A white or cream poster board (dollar store) bent in a curve from the wall down onto the table, held with tape or a stack of books. No corner line = clean, catalog look.	\$1-\$3
Reflector	A second white foam board (or a white pillowcase over a cereal box) standing on the side opposite the window. It fills the shadows so you can see the stitches.	\$1-\$3
Phone stand	A stack of books + a thick rubber band, or a mug with the phone leaning on it. For top-down shots: two chairs back to back with a broom handle across, phone taped on the handle.	\$0
Stuffing	Fill the backpack with a folded towel or crumpled tissue paper so it stands and looks full. Empty backpacks look sad and flat.	\$0
Lint roller + steam	Roll off fuzz and pet hair; hover a steam iron (never touch) over the flap so it lies flat.	\$0

TOP VIEW OF THE SETUP



Phone settings & habits

1. Wipe the lens with a soft cloth. A greasy lens is the #1 reason for “dreamy” (blurry) photos.
2. Turn on the grid (Camera settings → Grid). Put the backpack on the center lines.

3. Use the 1× lens, or 2× if your phone has a real telephoto. Never pinch-zoom — step closer instead.
4. Tap on the stitches and hold until you see AE/AF LOCK, then slide exposure down a little (−0.3). Stitches keep their detail.
5. Portrait mode OFF for product photos (it blurs edges of the yarn). Use it only for worn/lifestyle shots.
6. Shoot everything twice: once horizontal (Etsy) and once vertical 4:5 (Instagram, Marketplace).
7. Etsy crops thumbnails toward a horizontal 4:3 frame: leave empty space on the left and right of the backpack.
8. Edit in the free built-in editor only: Exposure +, Shadows +, Warmth 0, no filters. The color on screen must match the real yarn — wrong colors are the #1 reason for returns.

The 15 shots

#	SHOT	ANGLE	LIGHT	BACKGROUND	PROPS	WHAT IT'S FOR
1	The Hero	Straight on, camera at the height of the backpack's center	Window at 45° to one side, reflector opposite	White sweep	None	Etsy thumbnail and first photo everywhere. This is the photo that gets the click.
2	Three-quarter	Turned 45°, camera slightly above	Same as hero	White sweep	None	Shows depth and the side gusset. Photo #2 on Etsy.
3	Back & straps	Straight on from behind, straps pulled out in a soft V	Same	White sweep	None	Answers "are the straps adjustable/comfortable?" before they ask.
4	Open & inside	Top-down into the open bag	Soft, even (move reflector above)	White sweep	Snack box, small water bottle, crayons	Shows capacity and lining. Kills the "is it big enough?" doubt.
5	Scale shot	Eye level	Window light	Cream wall / chair	A child-size chair or a hand holding the top handle	Size in real life. Reduces "it was smaller than I thought" messages.
6	Worn shot	Back view at child height, no face needed	Natural light, outside in shade is perfect	Garden, school gate, front door	A child or a teddy bear on a chair	Lifestyle: the photo moms imagine. Best for Facebook and Instagram.
7	Stitch macro	10–15 cm / 4–6 in from the stitches, 2× lens	Side light (texture pops)	Fill the frame	None	Proves it's handmade and well made. Great 3rd–4th Etsy photo.
8	Closure detail	Close, slightly above	Side light	Fill the frame	None	Button, snap, drawstring or zipper: shows quality and how it closes.
9	Color menu	Top-down	Even, overcast-style light	White board	8–12 yarn balls in a row, each with a small numbered card	Your "ORDER MENU". Send it in DMs when someone asks for another color.
10	Styled flat lay	Top-down	Soft window light	Wood table or linen	Books, an apple, a lunch box, a pencil case, a sprig of flowers	Instagram grid post and Back-to-School posts.
11	Size diagram base	Straight on, perfectly square to the camera	Even	Cutting mat or grid paper	Tape measure laid along the bottom	Add the measurements (cm / in) on top with a free editor. Last Etsy photo.

#	SHOT	ANGLE	LIGHT	BACKGROUND	PROPS	WHAT IT'S FOR
12	Name close-up	Close, straight on the flap	Side light	Fill the frame	None	Sells personalization; use it on the "Personalized" listing and in DMs.
13	Gift wrap	Three-quarter	Warm window light	Cream or wood	Tissue paper, twine, your thank-you card, a kraft box	Shows it arrives ready to give. Converts gift buyers (grandmas!).
14	Process / hands	Over-the-shoulder or top-down, hands in frame	Window light	Your lap or table	Hook, yarn, half-finished piece	Reels and Stories: people buy from people. "20 hours in 20 seconds".
15	The family	Straight on or slightly above	Soft window light	White sweep or a shelf	3–5 backpacks lined up by size or color	Shop banner, Facebook cover, Marketplace "more available" photo, group posts.

THE ETSY PHOTO ORDER

Etsy photo order that works: 1 Hero · 2 Three-quarter · 6 Worn · 4 Open · 7 Macro · 3 Back · 12 Name (if personalized) · 9 Color menu · 13 Gift wrap · 11 Size diagram. Add a 5–15 s video of shot 2 while you rotate the bag.

THE 10-MINUTE PHOTO SESSION (EVERY NEW BACKPACK)

1. Stuff it, lint-roll it, steam the flap.
2. Shots 1, 2, 3, 4, 7, 8 on the sweep (5 frames each).
3. Shot 6 outside in the shade.
4. Pick the sharpest frame of each, edit Exposure/Shadows only.
5. Save to an album named after the product.

THE 5 MISTAKES THAT COST SALES

1. Yellow light from ceiling lamps.
2. A busy background (sofa, toys, rug).
3. Empty, floppy backpack.
4. Colors that don't match real life.
5. Only one photo. Etsy gives you 10 — use them all.

50 Copy-Paste DM & Comment Scripts

Change the words in [brackets] and send. Short, warm, and always ending with one easy question — that is how “so cute!” becomes “how do I order?”.

THE 4 RULES BEHIND EVERY SCRIPT

1. **Answer within 24 hours** — interest cools fast.
2. **Prices go in DMs**, never in public comments.
3. **Every message ends with one question** that's easy to say yes to.
4. **Maximum 2 follow-ups**. Warm, never pushy.

Launch

1 LAUNCH POST (YOUR PERSONAL PROFILE + STORIES)

Okay, I'm finally doing it 🧡 After making backpacks for my own kids for [time], I'm opening a tiny shop. Every backpack is crocheted by hand, one at a time, in the colors you choose — and yes, I can add their name. I have 3 ready right now and a few made-to-order spots for [month]. Comment “🧡” and I'll send you photos and details!

Asking for an emoji comment boosts the post and gives you a list of people to message.

2 PERSONAL DM TO A ★ CONTACT (ONE BY ONE)

Hi [Name]! I thought of you and [child's name] today 😊 I've started making crochet backpacks and I'm opening a few spots before [event]. No pressure at all — I just wanted you to see them first. Want me to send you a couple of photos?

Ask permission to send photos. A “yes” turns a cold pitch into a conversation.

3 FIRST POST IN A LOCAL MOM GROUP (SHOW & TELL)

Hi everyone! Local mom of [#] here 🧡 I crochet backpacks by hand — this one took me about [hours] hours and my daughter hasn't taken it off since. I make them in any color, with names, from toddler size to school size. Happy to answer any questions in the comments 🧡

Story + photo + no price. Let the group ask you.

“So cute!”

4 PUBLIC COMMENT: “SO CUTE!!” / “LOVE THIS!”

Thank you so much, [Name]! 🥰 It's one of my favorites to make. Do you have a little one who'd love one?

End every compliment reply with a question. A thank-you alone ends the conversation.

5 DM AFTER A COMPLIMENT (WITHIN 24 H)

Hi [Name]! Thank you for the sweet comment on my backpack 💛 I'm taking a few orders for [month] — would it be for your little one or a gift? I can send you the color options if you like.

6 “MY DAUGHTER WOULD LOVE THIS”

Aww, how old is she? 😊 I make them in toddler and school sizes, and I can stitch her name on the flap. What are her favorite colors?

Age + favorite colors = you already have everything to quote.

7 “DID YOU MAKE THIS?!”

I did! Every stitch 🧶 This one took about [hours] hours. I make them to order now — any color, and I can add a name. Would you like to see a few more?

8 “I WISH I COULD CROCHET LIKE THAT”

Thank you! It's a lot of hours and a lot of coffee ☕😁 The good news: you don't have to — I can make one for you. Who would it be for?

9 SOMEONE TAGS A FRIEND IN THE COMMENTS

Hi [Friend's name]! 🙌 [Name] thought you'd like this one. I have a couple of spots for [month] if you'd like one for your little one — happy to send details!

Tags are warm leads. Reply publicly, then send a DM.

“How much?”

10 “HOW MUCH?” (PUBLIC COMMENT)

Hi [Name]! I just sent you a message with the prices and sizes 📩

Never post prices in comments: you lose the conversation and invite comparison.

11 DM ANSWER: PRICE + VALUE + QUESTION

Hi [Name]! The toddler size is \$[price] and the school size is \$[price], made by hand in the colors you choose. A name on the flap is +\$[price]. It takes me [days] days to make. Would it be for a boy or a girl, and how old?

Price → what's included → timing → one question. In that order.

12 “HOW MUCH FOR THE ONE IN THE PHOTO?”

That exact one is \$[price] and it's ready to ship today 🎉 If you'd like it, I can hold it for you until [day]. Would you like me to?

Ready stock + a hold creates a gentle deadline.

13 ASKING PRICE FOR “A FEW” (PARTY FAVORS, TWINS, SIBLINGS)

I'd love to help! For 2 backpacks I take \$[amount] off the total, and for 3 or more \$[amount] off. How many would you need and by what date?

14 PRICE ASKED ON MARKETPLACE (“IS THIS STILL AVAILABLE?”)

Hi! Yes, it's available 😊 It's \$[price], handmade in cotton, and I can do local pickup in [area] or ship it. Would you like pickup or shipping?

Answer the question behind the question: logistics.

15 PRICE FOR A CUSTOM DESIGN THEY SAW ELSEWHERE

Thanks for sending the photo! I can make something in that style — a custom design like that is \$[price] because it's a new pattern for me. I can send you a sketch of the colors first. Want me to?

Shipping

16 “DO YOU SHIP?”

Yes! I ship within [country] for \$[price] (usually [x-y] days), and I can also do local pickup in [area]. Where would it be going?

17 INTERNATIONAL SHIPPING

I can! Shipping to [country] is about \$[price] with tracking and takes [x-y] weeks. Customs fees, if any, are charged by your country on delivery. Would you like me to check the exact cost?

18 “CAN YOU GET IT HERE BY [DATE]?”

Let me check! 📅 If you order by [date] I can have it made and shipped by [date], which usually arrives by [date]. I'd reserve the spot today so we don't cut it close. Shall I?

Always build in 3-4 extra days before a real deadline.

19 ASKING FOR A SHIPPING DISCOUNT / FREE SHIPPING

I totally get it! Shipping is free on orders of 2 or more, or you're welcome to pick up in [area] at no cost. Would one of those work for you?

20 ORDER SHIPPED (AFTER THEY PAY)

Great news, [Name]! 📦 [Child]'s backpack is on its way. It should arrive around [date]. I packed it with a little note — I hope she loves it!

Custom color

21 "CAN YOU MAKE IT IN PINK?"

Yes! 💖 Here are my pinks — just tell me the number you like. [send color menu photo] Would you like the straps in the same color or a contrast?

Send the color menu and give a second small choice: it makes her imagine the finished bag.

22 COLOR YOU DON'T HAVE IN STOCK

I love that idea! I don't have that exact shade right now, but I can order it (it takes [days] extra days). Or here are the 2 closest colors I have today. Which would you prefer?

23 "CAN YOU MAKE IT BIGGER/SMALLER?"

Yes, I can size it! My school size is [cm] cm / [in] in tall and fits a folder and lunch box; the mini is [cm] cm / [in] in. What would she carry in it?

Size by use, not by numbers.

24 TEAM/SCHOOL COLORS

Oh I love a school-colors backpack! Send me the two colors (a photo of the uniform or logo is perfect) and I'll match the yarn. Want me to add the name too?

25 UNSURE WHICH COLOR TO PICK

The top 3 my customers choose for [age]-year-olds are [color 1], [color 2] and [color 3]. If it's a gift, [neutral color] with a colorful name is always safe. Want me to send a photo of each?

26 CONFIRMING THE CUSTOM DETAILS (BEFORE STARTING)

Perfect, here's your order so you can double-check: [size] backpack · body [color #] · straps [color #] · name "[NAME]" in [color] · ready by [date] · total \$[price]. If everything looks right, reply "yes" and I'll send the payment link 😊

Written confirmation = zero "that's not what I asked for".

Price objection

27 "THAT'S EXPENSIVE" / "I CAN BUY ONE AT TARGET FOR \$20"

I completely understand! A store backpack is made by a machine in a few minutes; mine takes [hours] hours by hand, with her name, in the colors she picks — it's the one she'll keep in a box when she grows up. If you'd like a smaller budget option, the mini is \$[price]. Want to see it?

Acknowledge, explain the difference, offer a smaller option. Never lower the price of the same item.

28 "CAN YOU DO IT CHEAPER?"

I wish I could, but my prices only cover the yarn and my time. What I can do: skip the lining (– \$[amount]) or make the mini size (\$[price]). Would either work?

Remove something, never discount the same thing.

29 "I NEED TO ASK MY HUSBAND/PARTNER"

Of course! 😊 I'll send you two photos you can show him. I can hold your spot for [month] until [day] — just let me know either way.

30 "I'M GOING TO TRY TO MAKE IT MYSELF"

Love that! 🧶 It's such a fun project. If you run out of time before [event], my offer stands — just message me.

Leave the door open. Many come back two weeks before the event.

31 HAGGLING ON MARKETPLACE ("WOULD YOU TAKE \$30?")

Thanks for the offer! This one is firm at \$[price] because it's handmade — but if you take 2, I'll do \$[amount] for both. Let me know!

32 BUDGET IS THE REAL ISSUE

Totally fair! I can split it: a \$[deposit] deposit today holds your spot and the rest when it's ready. Would that make it easier?

Deposits turn "not this month" into "yes".

Maybe later

33 FOLLOW-UP TO "I'LL THINK ABOUT IT" (3–4 DAYS LATER)

Hi [Name]! Just checking in about the [color] backpack for [child] 😊 I have [#] spots left for [event/month]. Would you like me to keep one for you?

One short message, one question, a real number of spots.

34 FOLLOW-UP TO "AFTER PAYDAY" (ON PAYDAY)

Hi [Name]! Hope your week's going well 💛 You mentioned [date] would be better — I still have your [color] spot. Want me to send the payment link?

Follow-up

35 NO REPLY AFTER YOU SENT THE PRICE (2 DAYS)

Hi [Name]! Did the photos come through okay? 😊 Happy to answer any questions about sizes or colors.

Make the follow-up about helping, not about the sale.

36 SECOND AND LAST FOLLOW-UP (5–7 DAYS)

Hi [Name]! I don't want to bug you, so this is my last message about it 😊 If you'd like one later, just reply "backpack" anytime and I'll send you the current spots. Have a lovely week!

A polite last message gets surprisingly many replies.

37 SOMEONE FAVORITED YOUR ETSY LISTING (USE ETSY'S "OFFERS" TOOL IF AVAILABLE)

Hi [Name]! Thank you for adding my [product] to your favorites 🧡 In case it helps: I can personalize it with a name and I have [#] made-to-order spots for [month]. Any questions, I'm here!

38 AFTER THEY PAID THE DEPOSIT

Thank you so much, [Name]! 🎉 Your spot is officially reserved. I'll start [child]'s backpack on [date] and send you a progress photo halfway through.

Progress photos make the wait exciting and reduce "where is my order?" messages.

39 PROGRESS PHOTO

Look who's taking shape! 🥰 Here's [child]'s backpack so far. Next up: the straps and the name. Still on track for [date]!

40 ORDER READY — ASKING FOR THE BALANCE

It's finished!! 🧡 ✨ Here are the photos. The balance is \$[amount] — once it's in, I'll ship it (or we can set up pickup) on [day].

Custom order

41 SIBLING / FRIEND OFFER

Hi [Name]! Quick one: this month if you order 2 backpacks (siblings, cousins or best friends), you save \$10 on the pair. Thought of you since [child] has a [brother/sister/best friend] 🧡

42 NAME SPELLING CHECK

Just to be 100% sure before I stitch: the name is "[N-A-M-E]", with a capital [letter] only? Names are the one thing I can't undo 😊

43 REQUEST YOU CAN'T OR DON'T WANT TO DO (LICENSED CHARACTERS)

I love that she loves [character]! I can't make licensed characters, but I can make a [similar animal/colors] backpack inspired by her favorite colors. Want me to send you an idea?

Licensed characters can get your shop shut down. Offer an alternative instead.

44 PRE-ORDER ANNOUNCEMENT

🧡 PRE-ORDERS OPEN for [event]! I'm opening [#] made-to-order spots. A 50% deposit holds your spot, and your backpack will be ready by [date]. Once the spots are gone, they're gone — comment "SPOT" or send me a message!

A real number of spots and a real date. Update the count publicly as spots fill.

45 DEPOSIT & CUSTOM TERMS (SEND BEFORE PAYMENT)

Here's how custom orders work: 50% deposit to start, balance when it's finished. Because it's made just for you with a name, custom pieces can't be returned — but if anything isn't right with how it's made, I'll fix it. Sound good?

Closing

46 ASKING FOR A PHOTO + REVIEW (5-7 DAYS AFTER DELIVERY)

Hi [Name]! I hope [child] is loving the backpack 🧡 If you have a minute, a photo of it in action would make my day (face not needed!) — and if you ordered on Etsy, a quick review helps my little shop more than you know.

47 THE CLOSE: MOVING FROM CHAT TO ORDER

So that's the [size] in [color] with "[NAME]" for \$[price], ready by [date]. Would you like me to reserve it for you?

Summarize and ask a yes/no question. Most sales are lost because nobody asks.

48 ASK A HAPPY CUSTOMER TO SHARE

Thank you again, [Name]! Would you mind sharing the photo in your stories or your class group? It really helps a small shop like mine 🙏 As a thank-you, I'll take \$[amount] off your next order.

49 PAYMENT INSTRUCTIONS

Perfect! 🎉 I've created a private listing on Etsy just for you with everything we agreed — I'll send it here in a minute. As soon as it's paid, I start on [date].

Private Etsy listings keep payment safe for both of you.

50 DELIVERED: THANK YOU + NEXT OCCASION

Yay, it arrived! 🥳 Thank you for supporting my small shop, [Name]. If you ever need one for a birthday, a sibling or a friend's baby shower, you know where I am 🧡

This is the bridge to the repeat order.

PART 5

The Back-to-School & Holiday Order Calendar

Handmade takes time, so you sell before the rush, not during it. The US, the UK and Australia go back to school on completely different dates — here is when to post and when to open pre-orders for each.

Back-to-school dates by market

MARKET	FIRST DAY OF SCHOOL (TYPICAL)	OPEN PRE-ORDERS	LAST CUSTOM ORDER
 US South (GA, TN, AL, TX, FL, AZ...)	Late July – mid August	Mid June	~10 July
 US Midwest & West	Mid – late August	Early July	~25 July
 US Northeast (NY, NJ, MA, PA...)	After Labor Day (1st Monday of Sept)	Mid July	~10 August
 Canada	Day after Labour Day (early Sept)	Mid July	~10 August
 Scotland	Mid August	Late June	~25 July
 Ireland	Late August	Early July	~1 August
 England, Wales, N. Ireland	Early September	Mid July (schools break ~20 July)	~15 August
 Australia (Term 1)	Late January – early February	Early November (sell it as a Christmas gift)	~10 December (holiday post rush)
 New Zealand (Term 1)	Early February	Early November	~10 December

Exact dates change by school district and year — check your local school calendar each spring and write the real dates into the planner below.

The yearly events that sell backpacks

EVENT	DATE	MARKETS	START POSTING / PRE-ORDERS	WHAT TO MAKE
Valentine's Day	14 February	All	Mid January	Heart mini backpack, pink/red strawberry, Mommy & Me set
Mothering Sunday	March (3 weeks before Easter)	UK · IE	Mid February	Women's mini, granny square, striped retro

EVENT	DATE	MARKETS	START POSTING / PRE-ORDERS	WHAT TO MAKE
Easter	Moves every year: late March – late April	All	6–7 weeks before	Bunny backpack, pastel daisy, “Easter basket alternative”
Mother’s Day	2nd Sunday of May	US · CA · AU · NZ	Early April	Mommy & Me matching set, women’s mini, boho fringe
Preschool & kindergarten graduation	May – June	US · CA	Early April	Personalized name backpack “for big school”
End-of-year / teacher gifts	US late May–June · UK late July · AU mid December	All	4–6 weeks before	Pencil pouch, mini pouch, keychain (small add-ons)
Summer camp & travel	June – July	US · CA · UK	Early May	Drawstring bucket backpack, t- shirt yarn, name tag
Festival season	June – August	UK · IE · US	May	Boho fringe, granny square (women)
Back to school (North)	Mid July – early September	US · CA · UK · IE	Mid June – mid July	Name backpack, kindergarten set, school size
Halloween	31 October	US · CA (big) · UK · IE (growing)	Mid August – early September	Pumpkin trick-or-treat backpack, ghost, black cat
Diwali & autumn birthdays	October – November	All	September	Personalized pieces in jewel colors
Black Friday / Small Business Saturday	Friday & Saturday after US Thanksgiving (late Nov)	US · CA · UK	Announce 1 week before	Ready-made stock + bundles (never deep discounts: add a free pouch instead)
Christmas / holidays	25 December	All	Mid September – early October	Everything personalized, sibling sets, granddaughter gifts
Back to school (South)	Late January – early February	AU · NZ	Early November	Name backpack, kindergarten set (sell as Christmas gift)

Month by month

MONTH	POST (NORTHERN: US · CA · UK · IE)	POST (SOUTHERN: AU · NZ)	OPEN PRE-ORDERS FOR	MAKE / STOCK UP
January	New year, new backpack · Valentine's teasers · birthday gifts	Back-to-school countdown · last ready-made stock	Valentine's (mid Jan)	Hearts, reds and pinks; ready-made AU school stock
February	Valentine's last call (1–7 Feb) · Easter bunny reveal	First-day-of-school photos from customers	Easter & Mothering Sunday	Bunnies, pastels
March	Easter countdown · spring colors · Mothering Sunday (UK)	Autumn colors · Easter	Mother's Day US/AU	Pastel daisy, women's mini
April	Easter last call · Mother's Day sets · graduation	Easter · Mother's Day	Graduation & Mother's Day	Mommy & Me sets
May	Mother's Day last call · camp & summer	Mother's Day · winter warm tones	Summer camp, festival	Bucket backpacks, boho
June	Summer · strawberries & daisies · school's-out gifts	Mid-year birthdays	BACK TO SCHOOL (US South)	Start school stock: 2–3 ready-made neutrals
July	Back-to-school: "reserve your spot" · countdown	School holidays · birthdays	BACK TO SCHOOL (US, UK, CA, IE)	Name backpacks, kindergarten sets
August	Back-to-school last call · first-day photos	Spring colors	HALLOWEEN (mid Aug)	Pumpkins, black cats
September	First-day photos from customers · Halloween reveal	Spring · daisies	CHRISTMAS (mid Sept) · AU/NZ pre-announcement	Holiday stock begins
October	Halloween last call (by 15 Oct) · holiday gift guide	Halloween (small) · summer	Christmas (spots fill now)	Batch production: 60% of holiday orders
November	Small Business Saturday · holiday gift guide · last custom spots	BACK TO SCHOOL AU/NZ as a Christmas gift	AU/NZ back to school · last Christmas spots	Ready-made stock for last-minute buyers
December	Shipping cut-off reminders · ready-to-ship only after cut-off	Christmas + back-to-school combo	Valentine's (announce early Jan)	Rest 🌲 · plan next year

THE PRE-ORDER CAPACITY FORMULA

Spots = weeks until the deadline × backpacks you can finish per week.

Example: 10 hours a week ÷ 5 hours per school backpack = 2 per week. Six weeks before the first day of school = **12 spots**. Keep 2 back for last-minute friends.

SHIPPING CUT-OFFS

Carriers publish their holiday “last day to send” every autumn (usually mid-December for domestic post; earlier for international). Set your **last custom order date 10–14 days before** that cut-off, and after it switch to “ready to ship only”.

PRINTABLES

Your shop planners

Print these pages (or fill them in on a tablet). One pricing worksheet per product, one tracker for the 30 days, one order log you keep forever.

Pricing worksheet

PRODUCT	YARN & HARDWARE \$	HOURS	HOURS × \$12	+ \$5	TOTAL	ROUNDED PRICE
Example: women's mini backpack	\$20	5	\$60	\$5	\$85	\$85
Example: school backpack	\$14	4	\$48	\$5	\$67	\$70
Example: toddler mini	\$9	2.5	\$30	\$5	\$44	\$45

Pre-order capacity planner

EVENT	DEADLINE DATE	WEEKS LEFT	BACKPACKS / WEEK	SPOTS TO OPEN	OPENED ON	SPOTS FILLED

30-Day tracker

DAY	TASK	DONE ☐	MESSAGES	ORDERS	NOTES
1	Choose your 3 hero backpacks and price them				
2	Get 2 samples finished				
3	Set up your Phone Photo Studio and shoot the hero				
4	Open your Etsy shop and publish listing #1				
5	Publish listings #2 and #3 + shipping profiles				
6	Turn on Instagram for the shop				
7	Write your warm list of 50				
8	Soft launch: tell your people				
9	List 3 backpacks on Facebook Marketplace				
10	Join 5 local mom groups				
11	Your first group post: show & tell, not an ad				
12	Follow up everyone who reacted				
13	Make your color & name menu				
14	Weekly review: fix what nobody sees				
15	Your first Reel: "20 hours in 20 seconds"				
16	Etsy listings #4-#6: variations				
17	Open 5 pre-order slots for the next school event				
18	Ask your first customers for a photo and a review				
19	Share day				
20	Refresh Marketplace and groups				
21	Weekly review				
22	Launch a sibling / friend offer				
23	Post for the next date on your calendar				
24	Etsy listings #7-#9 + a listing video				
25	Second group round with proof				
26	Batch production day				
27	Follow up every "maybe later"				

DAY	TASK	DONE ☐	MESSAGES	ORDERS	NOTES
28	Open your next pre-order window (10 spots)				
29	Price check				
30	Month review and your next 30 days				

Order log

[illegible]

Your first order is closer than you think.

You don't need a big audience. You need three good photos, a listing that says the right words, and the courage to send one message to one mom.

Start with Day 1 today.